

087. Chapter 6 verses 33-35

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 6.33

अर्जुन उवाच ।
योऽयं योगस्त्वया प्रोक्तः साम्येन मधुसूदन ।
एतस्याहं न पश्यामि चञ्चलत्वात्स्थितिं स्थिराम् ॥ ३३ ॥

arjuna uvāca |
yo'yaṁ yogastvayā proktaḥ
sāmyena madhusūdana |
etasyāhaṁ na paśyāmi
cañcalatvātsthitim sthirām

- ◆ **arjunaḥ uvāca** – Arjuna said;
- ◆ **yaḥ ayam** – this; **yogaḥ** – Yoga; **tvayā** – by You; **proktaḥ** – taught;
- ◆ **sāmyena** – as equality/equanimity; **madhusūdana** – O Madhusudana;
- ◆ **etasya** – of this; **aham** – I; **na paśyāmi** – do not see;
- ◆ **cañcalatvāt** – because of restlessness; **sthitim** – foundation/steady state; **sthirām** – lasting;

Arjuna said: The system of Yoga that you have described and attainable by equality of mind, O Madhusudana, appears impractical and unattainable to me, due to the restless mind.

VERSE 6.34

चञ्चलं हि मनः कृष्ण प्रमाथि बलवद्दृढम् ।
तस्याहं निग्रहं मन्ये वायोरिव सुदुष्करम् ॥ 34 ॥

cañcalam hi manaḥ kṛṣṇa
pramāthi balavaddṛḍham |
tasyāham nigrahaṁ manye
vāyoriva suduṣkaram ||

- ◆ **cañcalam** – restless; **hi** – indeed; **manaḥ** – the mind; **kṛṣṇa** – O Krishna;
- ◆ **pramāthi** – turbulent; **balavat** – strong; **dṛḍham** – stubborn;
- ◆ **tasya** – of it; **aham** – I; **nigraham** – control; **manye** – think;
- ◆ **vāyoḥ iva** – like the wind; **su-duṣkaram** – very difficult.

The mind is very restless, turbulent, strong, and obstinate, O Krishna. It appears to me that it is more difficult to control than the wind.

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
असंशयं महाबाहो मनो दुर्निग्रहं चलम् ।
अभ्यासेन तु कौन्तेय वैराग्येण च गृह्यते ॥ 35 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
asaṁśayaṁ mahābāho
mano durnigrahaṁ calam |
abhyāsenā tu kaunteya
vairāgyeṇa ca gr̥hyate ||

- ◆ **śrī-bhagavān uvāca** – The Blessed Lord said;
- ◆ **asaṁśayaṁ** – without doubt; **mahābāho** – O mighty-armed;
- ◆ **manah** – the mind; **durnigrahaṁ** – difficult to curb; **calam** – restless;
- ◆ **abhyāsenā** – by practice; **tu** – but; **kaunteya** – O son of Kunti;
- ◆ **vairāgyeṇa** – by dispassion/detachment; **ca** – and; **gr̥hyate** – is restrained;

The Lord said: Doubtless, O mighty Arjuna, the mind is restless and hard to control; but by practice and by detachment, O son of Kunti, it can be restrained.